

While the digital home design guidelines will not mandate specific DRM and content protection solutions, the DHWG will provide a useful venue for those who share the digital home vision of device interoperability. Collaboratively, vendors can understand and document the range of technical and business requirements for achieving the required balance between protection, availability, and usability. This work will aid device designers and content providers in implementing Digital Rights Management methods available today and in the future, to foster an integrated, user-friendly, and backward compatible system that meets the rights, the needs, and the expectations of all stakeholders.

Manageability

Consumer adoption rates of digital home products will depend on the overall quality of experience users have, not just when using these products, but also when a problem arises involving one or more of them. The introduction of a variety of networked products into the home may make the resolution of issues by the consumer and support provider a difficult and expensive prospect. The more management information that can be given to the consumer in a meaningful manner about the health of their digital home devices, the less likely they are to require support. Should a consumer require support for a digital home device, they should know who to call and not be faced with the situation where they are passed on to another company without satisfactory resolution of their problem.

The DHWG will provide a useful venue for interested members to discuss and document technical and business issues for how digital home devices can be best managed and supported.

IEEE 1394 in the digital home

Home entertainment devices are increasingly moving from analogue to digital formats and interfaces. Devices such as TVs, AV receivers, and DVD players in the home entertainment cluster may use IEEE 1394 for short-distance, isochronous media transfer and control. 1394 also has the ability to transport IP, and this capability will enable UPnP technology over IP to extend its reach from the